

Operation Junction City

A classic search-and-destroy operation, Junction City was intended to deal a deathblow to the insurgents' infrastructure in South Vietnam. However, Viet Cong and NVA forces recognized the folly of trying to combat the US war machine and sought to outlast it instead.

◀◀ BEFORE

Previous efforts to clear the area northwest of Saigon had had mixed results.

LIMITED RESULTS

Operation **Cedar Falls** in the Iron Triangle a month before Operation Junction City resulted in heavy enemy casualties and the seizure of weapons and rice stockpiles. But US forces and the ARVN **lacked the resources to occupy and patrol the area**, and the population soon moved back in. This showed the limitations of such operations.

Operation Junction City was the largest joint US–ARVN operation of the war. Launched on February 22, 1967, it lasted 82 days and involved 45,000 US troops, including the war's only significant combat parachute assault. The primary area of operations, War Zone C in Tay Ninh province northwest of Saigon, was relatively flat and dry compared to the saturated paddies of the Mekong Delta and the steep hillsides of the Central Highlands. As a result, Operation Junction City saw the heaviest use of armored vehicles during the war.